

How Can You Make a Good Name With God?

Public Talk No. 55

Version: v0 delivery outline

Target length: 30 minutes including scripture readings

Introduction (05) 1 min

(Warm opening)

Have you ever walked past a garden and noticed a pleasant fragrance before you even saw the flower? Hidden flower; fragrance already made impression.

(Slight smile)

In a similar way, our name carries something. Honest; kind; trusted; people remember unusual things; plate at gathering.

But there is one Person whose view of our name matters more than anyone else's: Jehovah.

(Pause briefly)

So today we will consider this important question: How can you make a good name with God? Not only longtime servants; new ones; still learning; can start now.

A Good Name Is Valuable (06) 3 min

(Transition to scripture)

Please turn to Proverbs 22:1.

(Read; then pause)

Read Proverbs 22:1.

(Light humor)

A good name is more valuable than great wealth. People chase money; career; popularity; social media; coffee photo; coffee getting cold.

Human reputation has value, but it is not the highest goal. People's opinions change; praise today, forgotten tomorrow; morning mist.

Jesus warned us to store up treasures in heaven. Matthew 6:19, 20; Jehovah's approval; safest investment.

(Ask slowly)

The question is not only, "Do people like me?" What kind of name am I making with Jehovah?

Psalms 15:1, 2 shows what Jehovah values. Integrity; righteousness; truth in heart.

Think again of the flower. No signboard; gives off what is inside; good name comes from inner person.

We do not need to compete to have a good name with Jehovah. Not most talented; not most noticed; flower does not compare fragrance.

(Encourage new ones)

A good name with God is within reach. Ordinary people; faithful choices; day after day.

Why should we especially want a good name with God?

Why Make a Good Name With God? (09) 5 min

(New main section)

Please turn to Malachi 3:16.

(Read warmly)

Read Malachi 3:16.

Jehovah pays attention. Listens; fear Jehovah; meditate on his name; book of remembrance.

(Gentle humor)

This is encouraging for newer ones. Still learning; finding Bible books; table of contents; Jehovah notices sincerity.

It is like a careful gardener. Small shoot; others see little; gardener sees life and potential.

(Say, then pause)

Jehovah notices sincere beginnings.

Hebrews 11:6 says Jehovah rewards those earnestly seeking him. Prayer; study; meetings; changes; Jehovah sees.

(Reassuring tone)

People do not always see effort. Meeting attendance; courage through door; one-sentence comment; preparation; prayer.

Jehovah's view is complete. Heart; struggle; motive.

We owe Jehovah worship because he created us. Revelation 4:11; all things exist by his will.

But love is the main motivation. Not mere obligation; Psalm 116:12; "How can I respond?"

(Clear transition)

That leads to the practical question: How can you make a good name with God?

Four steps. Learn; obey; imitate; pray.

How Can You Make a Good Name With God? (14) 17 min

1. Learn About Jehovah (14) 4 min

(Point one clearly)

Please turn to John 17:3.

(Emphasize knowing)

Read John 17:3.

Everlasting life is connected with coming to know Jehovah and Jesus. More than facts; relationship.

(Let them picture it)

Knowing facts about a tree is not the same as knowing its value. Scientific name; height; soil; shade; fruit; experience.

Bible study is not just collecting information. What does this teach about Jehovah? loves? hates? treats people? views me?

Psalms 119:97 shows meditation is important. Rain on hard ground; truth soaking in.

Bible reading does not have to be rushed. Many chapters helpful; one verse deeply considered; small seed, large tree.

(Warm smile)

Learning takes time. Language; skill; friendship; one piano lesson; "Give it some time."

(Slow the questions)

After reading, ask simple questions. Jehovah? myself? what should I do?

James 4:8 gives a beautiful promise. Draw close; Jehovah draws close; not hesitant; warm response.

So keep learning about Jehovah. Bible students; rebuilding habits; friendship, not school assignment.

The first step is to keep learning about him.

2. Obey Jehovah's Commandments (18) 4 min

(Reassuring tone)

Please turn to 1 John 5:3.

(Emphasize not burdensome)

Read 1 John 5:3.

Love for God is shown by obedience. Commands not burdensome.

(Subtle hand gesture)

Jehovah's commands are protective. Riverbanks; not prison; guidance; water flows strongly.

His commands guide life in a clean direction. Thinking; family; conscience; friendship with Jehovah.

A fence around a lookout is not there to spoil the view. Enjoy safely; Jehovah sees dangers we do not.

This helps new ones understand obedience. Jehovah not harsh; Father; love, wisdom, protection.

(Gentle humor)

Obedience can be challenging. Psalm 103:14; Jehovah remembers dust; we surprise ourselves, not Jehovah.

Jehovah's patience helps sincere ones. Not excusing wrong; helping improvement.

Jehovah sees the difference. Loving wrong vs fighting weakness; slow progress; sincere effort.

(Tender reassurance)

Think of a child learning to walk. Parent delights in progress; Jehovah patient with those trying.

Ask Jehovah for help. Luke 11:11-13; holy spirit; Philippians 4:13; strength.

(Sincere prayer tone)

A practical prayer: "Jehovah, I want to obey you." Difficult area; help me want right; strength today.

Prayer like that builds a good name. Humility; dependence.

3. Imitate Jehovah's Qualities (22) 4 min

(Point three clearly)

Please turn to Psalm 25:4.

(Read as request)

Read Psalm 25:4.

David asked Jehovah to teach him His ways. Not "bless my chosen path"; teach me your path.

Imitating Jehovah means learning to think and feel like him. Amos 5:15; hate bad; love good.

A healthy body rejects spoiled food. Protects life; spiritual heart rejects what Jehovah hates.

The world trains people's tastes every day. Entertainment; advertising; conversation; wrong seems normal.

(Firm but warm)

Ask better questions. Is this allowed? Does Jehovah love this? What kind of person am I becoming?

Study Jesus to see Jehovah's qualities. John 14:9; Jesus perfectly reflected his Father.

Jesus' compassion teaches us Jehovah cares. Tired; sick; grieving; hungry; not interruptions.

Jesus' courage teaches Jehovah's standards are steady. Did not bend truth to please powerful men.

Jesus' patience teaches Jehovah's patience with us. Disciples misunderstood; argued; needed correction.

(Slow the questions)

When reading about Jesus, ask: How treat weak? pressure? defend Jehovah's name? imitate today?

This helps us make Jehovah's ways our ways.

4. Pray to Jehovah (26) 5 min

(Personal tone)

Please turn to Philippians 4:6.

(Read calmly)

Read Philippians 4:6.

(Light humor)

Jehovah speaks through the Bible; we speak by prayer. Friendship; voice notes; no reply; needs work.

Prayer is real communication with Jehovah.

First Peter 5:7 says Jehovah cares for us. Anxieties; decisions; weaknesses; gratitude; hopes.

Prayer may feel awkward at first. What to say? not performance; not impressive words; sincerity.

(Slow sample prayers)

Pray specifically. Control speech today; patience with family member; see Jehovah's help clearly.

Psalms 55:22 says to throw burden on Jehovah. Not show and take back; hand it over.

Proverbs 3:5, 6 says trust Jehovah. Decisions; prayed? Bible principles? effect on name with Jehovah?

Prayer helps us rely on Jehovah. Not ourselves; part of good name with him.

(Energetic summary)

The four steps work together. Learn; obey; imitate; pray; four strands in a strong cord.

Act Now to Make a Good Name With God (31) 4 min

(Conclusion begins)

We have seen that a good name with Jehovah is valuable. Jehovah notices sincere ones; build by learning, obeying, imitating, praying.

(Short pause)

When should a person start?

Isaiah 55:6 says search for Jehovah while he may be found. Clear point: do not delay.

(Light smile)

Some say, "Later, when life is less busy." Always one more message; errand; thing to fix.

Spiritual steps are best taken now.

(Compassionate tone)

Some may think, "I have made mistakes." Isaiah 1:18; set matters straight; Jehovah invites return.

Leaves after dust and rain. Dust washed away; receive light again; Jehovah cleanses repentant person.

Malachi 3:10 shows Jehovah generously blesses. Trust him; put worship first.

Psalm 119:1, 2 connects happiness with Jehovah's way. Wholehearted seeking; genuine happiness.

The good name that matters most is built with Jehovah. Not fame, wealth, popularity; sincere faith; steady action.

(Slow the list)

Return to the garden illustration. Small efforts: prayer; study; obedience; honesty; repentance; meeting while tired.

People may not notice all of that. But Jehovah does.

(Warm questions)

Ask yourself: "What does my name mean to Jehovah right now?" What step this week?

(Quiet conviction)

If we learn, obey, imitate, and pray, we can make a good name with God. Worth more than anything the world offers.